

Decimals: Find the Bug

Decimals Detective

Name: _____

Date: _____

Each case shows a kid's decimal work with one planted error. Circle the wrong step, check the suspect that did it, then rewrite the work correctly on the lines.

1. Case 1: Maya adds $0.5 + 0.25$. Her answer: 0.30 .

Maya's work:
 0.5
 $+ 0.25$

 0.30
She stacked the numbers flush right, like whole numbers.

☐ Bug circled
SUSPECTS:
☐ Line-Up Slip
☐ Trailing-Zero Myth
☐ Place Swap
Fix:

☐ Re-checked my fix

2. Case 2: Dev compares 1.2 and 1.20 . He says 1.20 is bigger.

Dev's claim: " 1.20 has more digits, so $1.20 > 1.2$."
He read 1.20 as one hundred twenty and 1.2 as just twelve.

☐ Bug circled
SUSPECTS:
☐ Line-Up Slip
☐ Trailing-Zero Myth
☐ Place Swap
Fix:

☐ Re-checked my fix

3. Case 3: Sam writes seven hundredths for the point on the line.

The number line shows a point at 0.7 .
Sam labels it: "seven hundredths, 0.07 "

☐ Bug circled
SUSPECTS:
☐ Line-Up Slip
☐ Trailing-Zero Myth
☐ Place Swap
Fix:

☐ Re-checked my fix